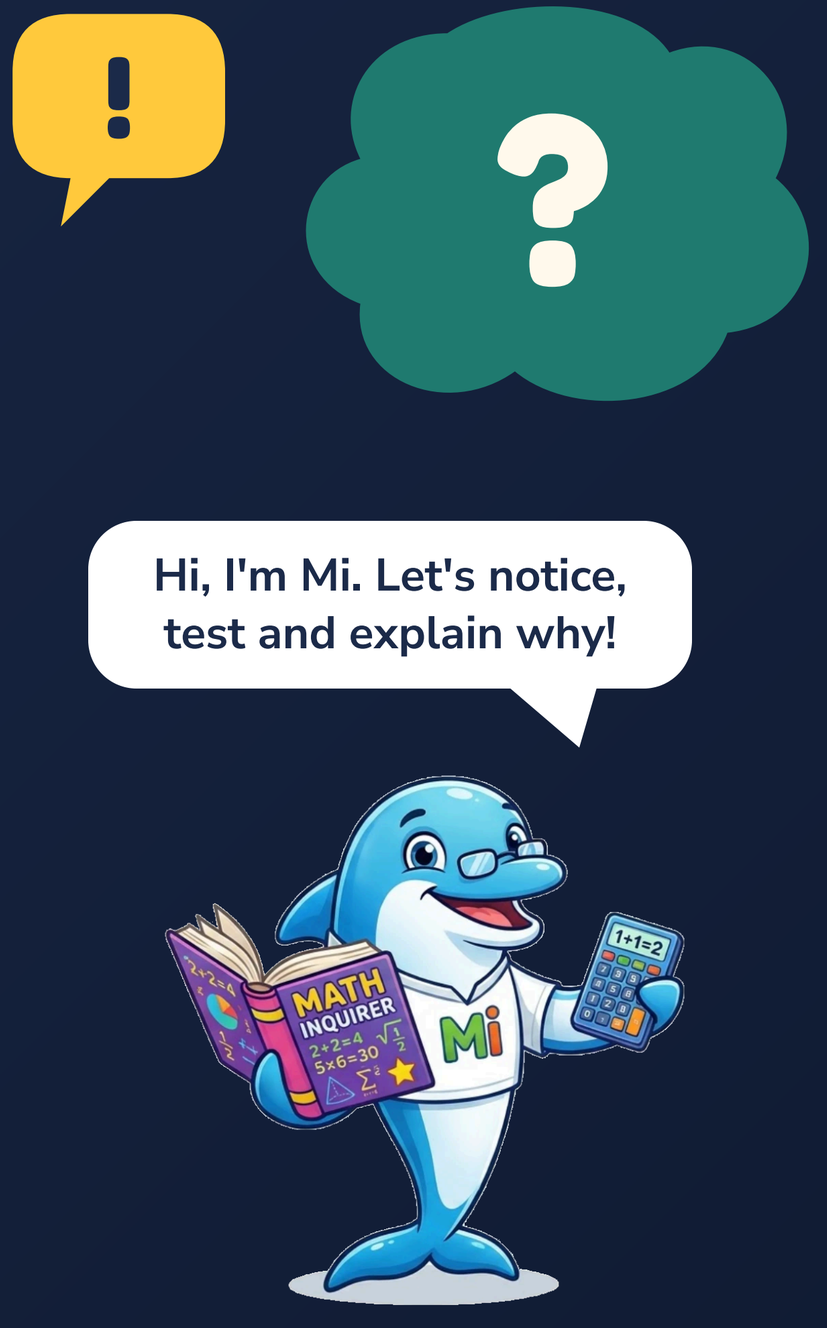
LESSON 3 • TERM 1 • LEVEL 1

Digit Cards

Whole numbers: compare and order

TODAY WE WILL

Make numbers with digit cards, and say which is greater.



0–2 MIN

Get ready

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

- Your digit cards, 0 to 9, face up.
- Your tens bars and ones squares.
- A pencil and your workbook.

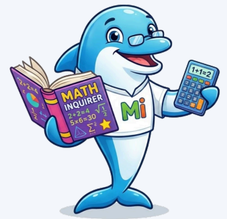
2–8 MIN

Warm-up: count in tens

Clap on every number

10	20	**30**	40	**50**	60	**70**	80	**90**	100

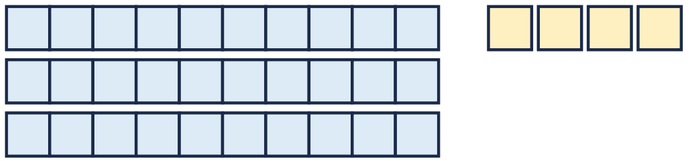
Now count back from 100. Whisper, and shout on 50!



Clap along with me!

Tens and ones

2–8 MIN



Tens	Ones
3	4

3 bars and 4 squares

25 40 **17** 63

A DIGIT

One of the symbols 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9.

In 34, the left digit counts the tens. The right digit counts the ones.

More or fewer?

2–8 MIN



Group A



Group B

Which group has more squares?

8–12 MIN

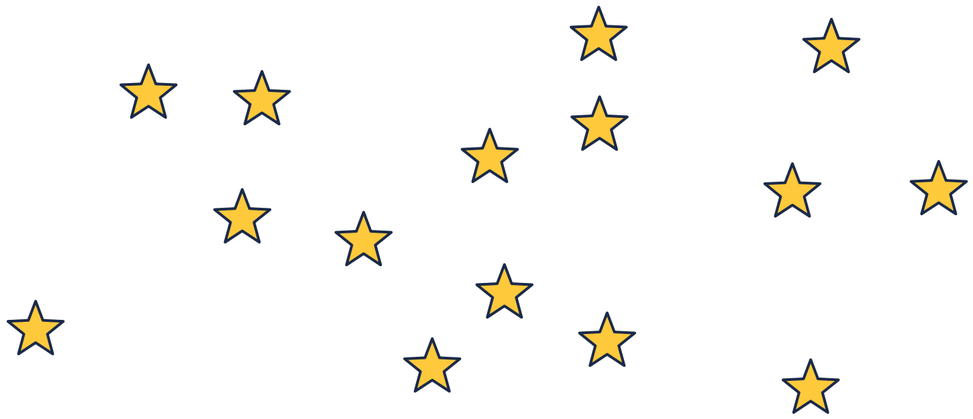
Sneak-peek puzzle 1

Ideas we have not learnt yet. A guess is a great start. Nobody is marked.

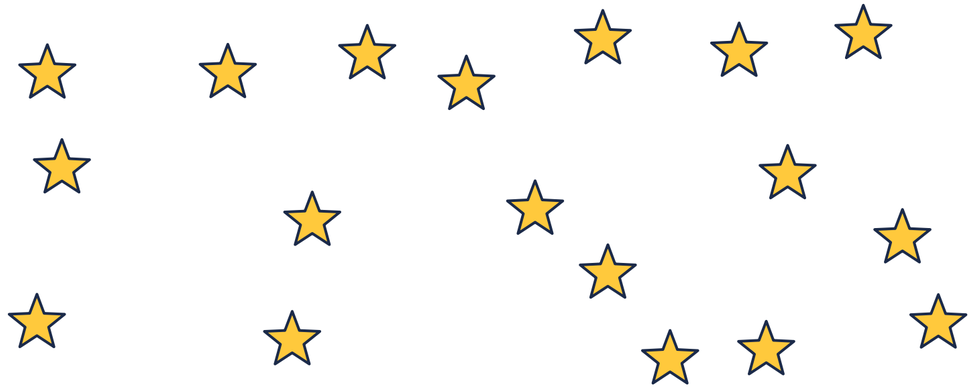
PUZZLE 1: anyone can try

Count the stars in each box. Which box has more? Write how many.

Box A



Box B



Sneak-peek puzzle 2

8–12 MIN

PUZZLE 2: think

Ali has the digit cards 4 and 8.

He puts the 4 first and makes 48.

Mei swaps the cards and makes a new number.

Who has the greater number? Circle Ali or Mei. I know because ___.

4 8

Explore: two cards, two numbers

12–28 MIN

1. Put your digit cards face up.
2. Pick two cards. Put them side by side.
3. Read your number. Say the tens first.
4. Swap the cards. Read the new number.

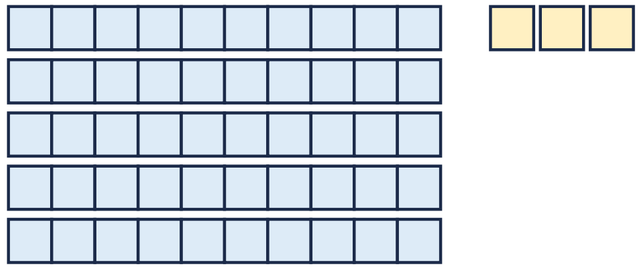
WHAT IF?

What if one of your cards is 0?

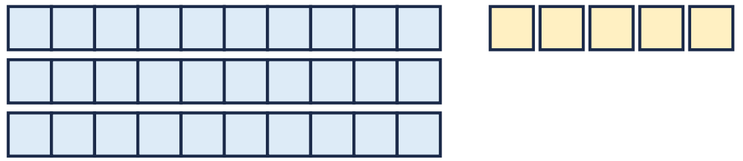
12–28 MIN

Build both numbers

Build both of your numbers with bars and squares. Which pile has more?



53



35

Show me!

12–28 MIN

Hold it up to the camera when I count to three.

Cards	Make the
7 and 2	greatest number
3 and 9	greatest number
0 and 5	greatest number
6 and 1	smallest number
8 and 5	smallest number

What did we notice?

12–28 MIN

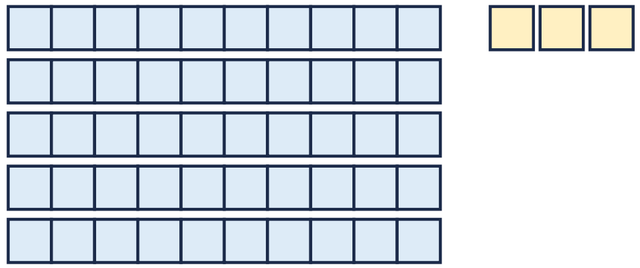
- Which card goes on the left for the greatest number?
- Which card goes on the left for the smallest number?
- What happens with a 0 card? Could you make 05?

28–38 MIN

Two cards, two numbers



35



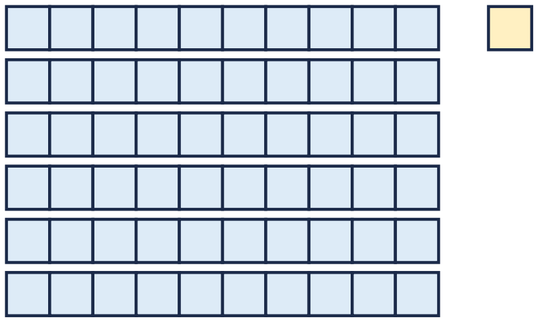
53

3 5

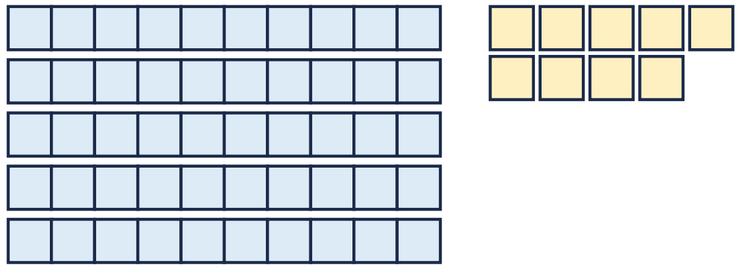
Same cards. The left card counts the tens.

28–38 MIN

Which is greater? Tens first



61



59

THE RULE

Look at the tens first.

Same tens? Then look at the ones.

28–38 MIN

Your turn: which is greater?

Write the greater number each time. Timer: 1 minute

1. 28 or 82
2. 61 or 59
3. 34 or 38

28–38 MIN

Check: which is greater?

28 or 82

82

61 or 59

61

34 or 38

38

28–38 MIN

Greatest and smallest



Greatest: greatest card on the left

72

Smallest: smallest card on the left

27

28–38 MIN

The 0 card

0 **6**

- 6 then 0 is 60. A two-digit number.
- 0 then 6 is 06. That is just 6.

A number does not start with 0.

28–38 MIN

Put them in order

Smallest first. Tens first!

45 54 39 40

38–42 MIN

Tall and small

First number greater? Reach up tall.

First number smaller? Curl down small.

The same? Hands on hips.

NUMBER PAIRS

52 and 25

38 and 83

61 and 59

40 and 40

19 and 21

Sip some water.

42–70 MIN

Workbook page 1: Start here

Questions 1 to 3. Timer: 8 minutes

S1 You have two digit cards: 3 and 5. Make two numbers with both cards.

S2 Write the greater number each time.

S3 Count the bars and squares in Mei's picture. Ben has 4 bars and 1 square.



42–70 MIN

Check page 1

S1	35 and 53. 53 is greater.
S2	72, 48, 65, 30
S3	Mei 38, Ben 41, Ben has more

42–70 MIN

Workbook page 2: Start here

Questions 4 to 8. Timer: 10 minutes

S4 Make two numbers with both cards 6 and 2.

S5 Arrange these in order. Begin with the smallest number: 52, 25, 41, 14.

S6 Kumar says that 19 is greater than 21.

S7 You have the cards 2 and 8. Use both cards each time.

S8 Siti has 25 stickers. Ravi has 52 stickers. Draw bars and squares in the box.

42–70 MIN

Check page 2

S4	62 and 26
S5	14, 25, 41, 52
S6	No. 21 is greater. 2 tens is more than 1 ten.
S7	82 and 28
S8	Ravi (52 is 5 tens and 2 ones; 25 is 2 tens and 5 ones)

42–70 MIN

Choose your next page

Page	What it is
Think harder (page 3)	Our idea in a new setting
Go further (page 4)	Bigger puzzles
Investigation (page 5)	A pattern to find
Check	Finish and check your own work

Everyone may choose. You can swap at any time.

Talk and explain

70–76 MIN

TALK ABOUT IT

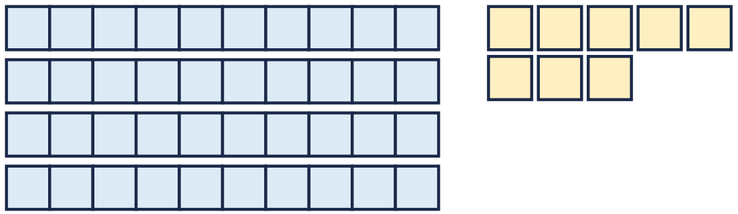
Put the smallest card on the left to make the smallest number.

Is this always right? Try the cards 3 and 8. Then try the cards 0 and 5.

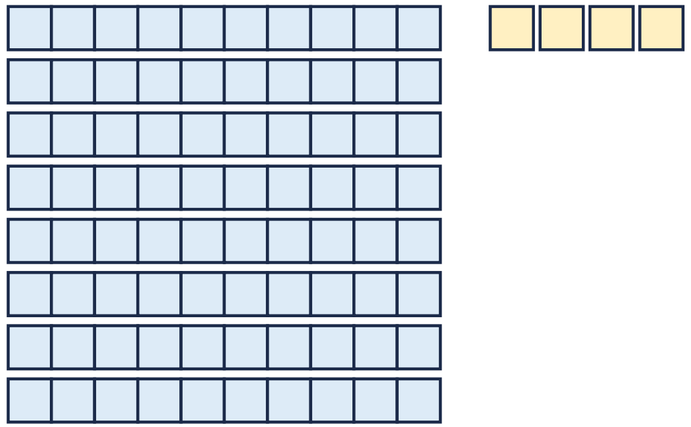
I think … because …

Back to the sneak-peek

70–76 MIN



Ali: 48



Mei: 84

Puzzle 1: box B, 18 stars. Puzzle 2: Mei has the greater number, 84.

Exit ticket

76–82 MIN

On your own. No looking back. Timer: 3 minutes

E1 Write the greater number: 39 or 41.

E2 Make two numbers with both cards 7 and 3.

E3 Arrange these in order. Begin with the smallest number: 63, 36, 60.

Check the exit ticket

76–82 MIN

E1	41
E2	73 and 37
E3	36, 60, 63

Look-back

82–85 MIN

Three minutes. There are no right answers. You can pass. Nobody reads it out.

Something I did well	write or draw one thing
The hardest part was …	☐ knowing which card goes on the left ☐ looking at the tens first ☐ the 0 card ☐ listing every number (Think harder) ☐ something else
What helped me	☐ digit cards or my kit ☐ drawing it ☐ trying again ☐ I asked for help ☐ I was not stuck
Next time I will try	☐ using my cards ☐ building it with the kit ☐ checking my answer ☐ asking a question
	☐ I am still stuck (my tutor will come and help) ☐ I would like to pass

Take your time. You can pass.



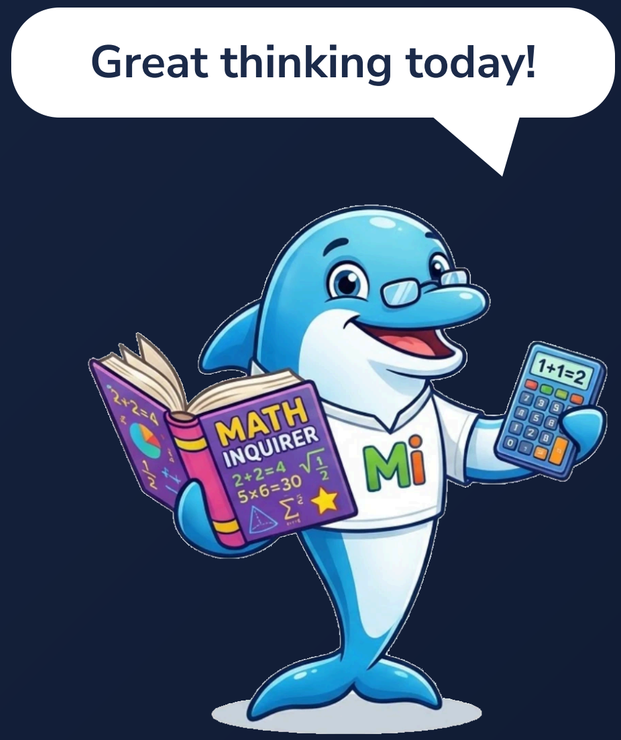
85–90 MIN

Well done, inquirers!

Show a grown-up one thing you found out today.

Next lesson: The 100 Square Explorer.

You need a pencil, paper and colouring pencils.



OPTIONAL

Go further: what if?

How many two-digit numbers have two matching digits, like 33?

Write them all. What do you notice?

33 44

OPTIONAL

If we have time: pick one

Activity	What we do
Is it always true?	Is the greater card on the left always the greater number? Test it.
Make a puzzle	Write a digit card puzzle for your grown-up
Teach it back	Show how to tell 61 is greater than 59

Optional. Everyone may join.